

3.5.1 Qualitative skills and quantitative skills

Students should develop the following with respect to **qualitative data**:

- use and understanding of a mixture of methodological approaches, including interviews
- interpretation and evaluation of a range of source material including textual and visual sources
- understanding of the opportunities and limitations of qualitative techniques such as coding and sampling, and appreciation of how they actively create particular geographical representations
- understanding of the ethical and socio-political implications of collecting, studying and representing geographical data about human communities.

Students should develop the following with respect to **quantitative data**:

- understanding of what makes data geographical and the geospatial technologies (eg GIS) that are used to collect, analyse and present geographical data
- an ability to collect and to use digital and geo-located data, and understanding of a range of approaches to use and analyse such data
- understanding of the purposes and difference between the following and be able to use them in appropriate contexts:
 - descriptive statistics of central tendency and dispersion
 - descriptive measures of difference and association, inferential statistics and the foundations of relational statistics
 - measurement, measurement errors, and sampling
- understanding of the ethical and socio-political implications of collecting, studying and representing geographical data about human communities.